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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Legal Secretary / Legal Assistant position in the Conveyancing team at Canary Wharf because my background in legal file management, document preparation and client communication maps directly onto what this kind of support role requires, and I am looking to build sustained, practical legal experience in a transactional environment.

The clearest evidence of relevant capability comes from my year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, where I supported a busy Real Estate Disputes team alongside a complex international arbitration matter. In the Real Estate team I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, managed court filings, tracked deadlines across several competing matters and maintained organised matter records in iManage. That work required me to keep multiple files in good order simultaneously, meet firm external deadlines without prompting and communicate clearly with fee earners and clients about what was needed and when. The document and file management disciplines developed in that role translate well to conveyancing case administration.

At Citizens Advice I manage cases from initial instruction through to submission: I take detailed client statements, draft correspondence, prepare application documents and maintain confidential case records. Working with clients on housing and welfare matters has also meant communicating procedural requirements clearly to people who are often under significant pressure, and translating complex rules into practical, actionable guidance. That client-facing side of the work is something I take seriously, and I think it is directly relevant to the kind of contact a legal secretary or assistant in a conveyancing team maintains with buyers, sellers and other parties through a transaction.

Conveyancing is a practice area I want to develop properly rather than pass through. My Real Estate Disputes experience at BCLP gave me a grounding in property law issues including leasehold, easements and landlord and tenant matters, and working through those disputes gave me a clear picture of what can go wrong in a transaction when the underlying documentation or process is not handled carefully. That has made me more interested in the transactional side, where getting the process right from the outset is what protects the client.

I am available to start promptly and would welcome the chance to discuss the role further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva